encouraged this murder. He mentioned recent antisemitic statements made by prominent Turks:

> amid president-elect Recep Tayyip Erdoğan's thundering speeches that, "Israel was worse than Hitler," and regular attacks on Israel's diplomatic missions in Ankara and Istanbul, including rocks thrown at—and hundreds of angry Turks trying to break into—the diplomatic compounds. The mayor of Ankara, Melih Gökcek, was quoted as saying: "We will conquer the consulate of the despicable murderers." The Jewish couple had already been slain. But fortunately, this was not a crime motivated by anti-Semitism. The police quickly caught the suspects, an Uzbek couple who worked for the Karakos. They confessed to the killing. It was a simple criminal act like hundreds of others committed in Turkey every day. All the same, the poor couple's funeral service at the Ulus Ashkenazi Jewish cemetery was revealing. In fear of an attack, tight security scanned every guest. If you are a Jew in Turkey, not even a funeral is peaceful. All synagogues in Turkey—as well as Jewish (and some other non-Muslim) schools—are heavily protected. In April, a Turkish judge shared the following *magnum opus* on his Facebook account: "We love you Recep Tayyip Erdoğan. We love you because those who do not love you, do not love this nation; Because Zionist Israel and its conspirators do not love you; Because the world's oppressed and Muslims love you; Because you are one of us, one of your nation; May God save you and make you victorious, for us". . . . upon Erdoğan's election victory on March 30, 2014, he wrote that, "The losers (at the ballot box) are Zionists and their conspirators." Just imagine a Turkish Jew having a legal dispute with a Muslim Turk and facing this judge in the courtroom. . . .[40]

Bekdil mentions other examples as well. His bottom line, in particular, should be reason for serious concern. According to Bekdil, the Jews of Turkey should leave Turkey as soon as possible or in his own words, "leave while you can before the second holocaust happens." Clearly there has been a dangerous escalation of antisemitism in Turkey, encouraged from above and below. The chain reactions we have described and analyzed blurred the lines between anti-Israel hatred and antisemitism to the point of disappearance. This assault was led by Erdoğan himself, thus granting it full legitimacy. The results have been disastrous.

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